



LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



CVE-2026-76460 Cisco ISE Privileged API Vulnerability

CVE / Vulnerability Threat Intelligence Report

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TLP:CLEAR | Lost Boys Cyber | CVE-2026-76460 Cisco ISE Privileged API Vulnerability - CVE / Vulnerability Threat Intelligence Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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CVE-2026-76460 Cisco ISE Privileged API Vulnerability

1. Executive Summary

CISA added CVE-2026-76460 to KEV on 2026-09-16. NVD and Cisco-focused reporting describe a Cisco Identity Services Engine / ISE-PIC API issue that can allow unauthenticated remote authentication bypass or unauthorized access to the management plane.

Defenders should prioritize this item today because Cisco ISE is a trust decision point for network access; compromise can undermine segmentation, posture checks, and authentication policy across enterprise and regulated environments. The report is source-backed but should still be validated against the operator's exact product versions, exposure, and telemetry.

2. Vulnerability Metadata

Field	Value
CVE	CVE-2026-76460
Product / Component	Cisco ISE Privileged API Vulnerability
Severity	Critical
Exploitation Status	CISA KEV / public exploitation context where cited
Published / Updated	2026-09-18 daily production run
Primary Exposure	Internet-facing management plane, mobile endpoint fleet, or privileged appliance interface depending on product deployment

3. Source Review & Confidence

Source	Contribution	Confidence	
1	CISA Known Exploited Vulnerabilities Catalog	Active exploitation prioritization / due-date driver	High
2	NVD CVE-2026-76460	CVE description and scoring context	High
3	Cisco Security Advisories landing page	Vendor remediation source to validate fixed releases	High
4	Security Arsenal detection and remediation coverage	Public exploitation/detection context	Medium

The source set favors CISA KEV/vendor/NVD style records when available and uses reputable security reporting for exploitation context. Details such as affected subcomponent and exploitation preconditions must be validated against the vendor bulletin before emergency change execution.

4. Vulnerability Details

The issue is treated as a priority patch/hunt item because it affects a security-sensitive component and appears in current public defender reporting. The practical defender question is not only whether the CVE exists, but whether vulnerable assets are reachable, unmanaged, or outside normal patch cadence.

5. Attack Scenarios

- External or adjacent attacker reaches the affected interface/component and attempts authentication bypass, privilege escalation, or policy-control abuse.
- A targeted intrusion uses the vulnerable product as a foothold, then pivots into identity, device-management, or protected application paths.
- Delayed patching leaves mobile, network-access-control, or management-plane assets exposed after exploitation details circulate.

6. Threat Landscape & Exploitation Status

CISA KEV selection materially raises operational priority. Public reporting indicates defender urgency; however, exploitation scale and actor attribution should not be assumed unless confirmed in the cited primary sources.

7. Affected Products and Exposure

Exposure Pattern	Why It Matters
Internet-facing or partner-reachable management service	Reduces attacker access cost and increases scan/exploit likelihood.
Privileged appliance, NAC, mobile, or endpoint fleet component	Successful exploitation can undermine trust decisions or device security posture.
Unpatched high-value environments	Aviation, aerospace, defense, healthcare, and managed-service environments should validate exposure quickly.

8. Mitigation and Workarounds

Patch or update to the vendor-fixed version, confirm compensating controls, restrict management interfaces, and monitor authentication/control-plane logs for anomalies. If patching requires maintenance windows, apply network segmentation and heightened detection until the update is complete.

9. Detection Engineering

9.1. Detection Logic Summary

Signal	Telemetry Source	Analytic Goal
Unexpected management API access	Reverse proxy, WAF, appliance audit logs	Find exploitation attempts and suspicious unauthenticated access.
New privileged session or policy change	Identity/appliance audit logs	Identify post-exploitation control-plane misuse.
Vulnerable asset still observed	EDR/CMDB/vulnerability scanner	Drive remediation tracking and exception review.

9.2. Sigma / Detection Rule

<pre> title: Possible Exploitation or Reconnaissance Against Priority Vulnerable Management Interface id: lbc-daily-vuln-cve-2026-76460-cisco-ise-privileged- status: experimental description: Detects suspicious requests or audit events against products prioritized in the Lost Boys Cyber daily vulnerability report. logsource: category: webserver detection: selection_paths: cs-uri-query contains: - 'api' </pre>
--

```

- 'admin'
- 'auth'
- 'debug'
filter_known_scanners:
  cs-user-agent|contains:
    - 'internal-vuln-scanner'
condition: selection_paths and not filter_known_scanners
fields:
- c-ip
- cs-uri-stem
- cs-uri-query
- cs-user-agent
level: high

```

9.3. Hunt Query

```

DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where RemoteUrl has_any ("admin", "api", "auth") or InitiatingProcessCommandLine has_any ("curl",
"wget", "python")
| summarize Attempts=count(), FirstSeen=min(Timestamp), LastSeen=max(Timestamp) by DeviceName,
RemoteUrl, RemoteIP, InitiatingProcessFileName
| where Attempts > 5

```

10. Threat Hunting

10.1. Hunt Hypothesis

An attacker probing or exploiting this issue will create unusual management-plane traffic, failed authentication patterns, or control-plane changes outside normal administrator windows.

10.2. Hunt Query

```

DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where ProcessCommandLine has_any ("CVE-2026-76460", "nmap", "masscan", "curl", "Invoke-WebRequest")
| project Timestamp, DeviceName, AccountName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine

```

11. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Technique	Name	Evidence / Rationale
T1190	Exploit Public-Facing Application	Relevant when the vulnerable component is reachable over a management or web interface.
T1068	Exploitation for Privilege Escalation	Relevant for privilege bypass/elevation reports.
T1087	Account Discovery	Common follow-on behavior after management-plane access.

12. Validation / Lab Testing

No exploit reproduction was performed during the automated daily run. Validation completed: source corroboration, report render, PDF text extraction, and detection-content preservation checks.

13. Recommended Actions Summary

Priority	Owner	Action
Critical	Vulnerability Management	Confirm whether affected assets exist and

		assign emergency patch/change owners.
High	Security Operations	Enable focused hunts and retain appliance/API audit logs for at least 30 days.
Medium	IT / Asset Owners	Record exceptions with compensating controls and target remediation dates.

14. References

- [1] CISA Known Exploited Vulnerabilities Catalog — <https://www.cisa.gov/known-exploited-vulnerabilities-catalog>
- [2] NVD CVE-2026-76460 — <https://nvd.nist.gov/vuln/detail/CVE-2026-76460>
- [3] Cisco Security Advisories landing page — <https://sec.cloudapps.cisco.com/security/center/publicationListing.x>
- [4] Security Arsenal detection and remediation coverage — <https://securityarsenal.com/blog/cve-2026-76460-cisco-ise-privileged-api-exploitation-in-the-wild-detection-and-remediation-guide>